

Yiwei Chen

 Github |  Homepage |  LinkedIn |  Google Scholar

EDUCATION

Michigan State University

East Lansing, USA

- **Ph.D. in Computer Science**

Aug. 2024 -

Advisor: Prof. [Sijia Liu](#)

Xi'an Jiaotong University

Xi'an, China

- **M.S. in Computer Science and Technology.**

Sept. 2021 - Jun. 2024

- **B.Eng. in Automation.**

Sept. 2017 - Jun. 2021

Honor Class in Qian Xuesen Honors College.

- **Special Class for Gifted Young.**

Sept. 2015 - Jun. 2017

A honor program for nationwide selected gifted young students.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Reasoning, Post-training, LLMs, MLLMs, Agentic System
- AI Safety, Alignment, Trustworthy Algorithms, Interpretability, Machine Unlearning

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

(* means Equal Contribution)

- [1] **Y. Chen***, Y. Yao*, Y. Zhang, B. Shen, G. Liu, S. Liu. "Safety Mirage: How Spurious Correlations Undermine VLM Safety Fine-Tuning and Can Be Mitigated by Machine Unlearning." *ICLR*, 2026. [\[Paper\]](#)
- [2] **Y. Chen***, S. Pal*, Y. Zhang, Q. Qu, S. Liu. "Unlearning Isn't Invisible: Detecting Unlearning Traces in LLMs from Model Outputs." *ICLR*, 2026. [\[Paper\]](#)
- [3] **Y. Chen**, B. Shang, S. Liu. "Who Built This Model? Tracing LLM Lineage via Spectral Fingerprints in Weight Space." *COLM*, 2026. [\[Paper\]](#)
- [4] **Y. Chen**, L. Li, K. Cheung, V. Parla, G. Sundaram. "Data-Centric Benchmarking of Exploit Generation in LLMs: Understanding the Impact of Fine-Tuning." Manuscript, 2026. [\[Paper\]](#)
- [5] B. Shang*, **Y. Chen***, Y. Zhang, B. Shen, S. Liu. "Forgetting to Forget: Attention Sink as A Gateway for Backdooring LLM Unlearning." *COLM*, 2026. [\[Paper\]](#)
- [6] Z. Zhang*, **Y. Chen***, W. Zhang, C. Yan, Q. Zheng, Q. Wang, W. Chen. "Tile Classification Based Viewport Prediction with Multi-modal Fusion Transformer." *ACM-MM*, 2023. [\[Paper\]](#)
- [7] Y. Zhang, C. Wang, **Y. Chen**, C. Fan, J. Jia, S. Liu. The Fragile Truth of Saliency: Improving LLM Input Attribution via Attention Bias Optimization. *NeurIPS Spotlight*, 2025. [\[Paper\]](#)
- [8] H. Reisizadeh, J. Ruan, **Y. Chen**, S. Pal, S. Liu, M. Hong. Leak@k: Unlearning Does Not Make LLMs Forget Under Probabilistic Decoding. *ICML*, 2026. [\[Paper\]](#)

INTERNSHIPS

Amazon, Applied Scientist Intern

May 2026 - Aug. 2026

Research Project: World Models for GUI Agents

- Developed world-modeling methods for GUI agents to predict interface state transitions, support action planning, and improve agent reliability in interactive environments.

- Built a data-centric benchmark and fine-tuned Qwen3-8B for CVE-conditioned exploit generation, achieving a +42.5% improvement over the base model, comparable with closed-source LLMs.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

OPTML, Michigan State University

Research Assistant. Advisor: Prof. Sijia Liu

East Lansing, US

Aug. 2024 -

- *Multi-Agent Systems*: Proposed a multi-agent test-time training framework that decouples inter-agent communication from fast-weight updates and enables adaptive state refinement during inference.
- *GUI Agents*: Studied GUI-agent systems with a focus on world modeling, state prediction, action planning, and memory-based agent decision making in interactive environments.
- *Trustworthy Foundation Models* [1], [2], [3], [5]: Studied how to make foundation models more reliable, accountable, and robust after training, focusing on safety alignment, knowledge removal, model provenance, and hidden vulnerabilities that may persist or emerge during fine-tuning and unlearning.

AWARDS & HONORS

SCHOLARSHIPS

- Michigan State University Travel Award
 - Outstanding Master Graduate, Xi'an Jiaotong University (Top 5% of all graduates)
 - Outstanding Bachelor Graduate, Xi'an Jiaotong University (Top 5% of all graduates)
 - Outstanding Freshman Scholarship, Xi'an Jiaotong University (Top 10%)
 - First Prize Scholarship, Xi'an Jiaotong University (Top 10%)
- Oct. 2025
- Jun. 2024
- Jun. 2021
- Nov. 2021
- Nov. 2016-2019, 2022-2023

COMPETITIONS

- Meritorious Winner in Mathematical Contest in Modelling (top 8% in 25370 teams)
 - The First Prize in Shaanxi of China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling
- Mar. 2019
- Oct. 2018

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- **Conference Reviewer:** ICLR, ICASSP, NeurIPS, ACM-MM, IJCNN
- **Journal Reviewer:** Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR)

LANGUAGE & SKILLS

Language	Mandarin (Native), English (Professional)
Programming	Python, C/C++, Bash, LaTeX, MATLAB, HTML/CSS
Model Frameworks	LLMs (e.g., Llama, Qwen), MLLMs (e.g., LLaVA, Qwen-VL)
Libraries / Softwares	Pytorch, Tensorflow, Deepspeed, Huggingface, OpenCV
Developer Tools	Git, Docker, Vim, VSCode, Cursor, Claude Code, PyCharm